

QUESTION 1

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Claim-Example Match

DIFFICULTY: EASY

PROMPT: The Hollow by the River is a 1923 novel by Margaret Ellison. In the novel, the character Thornton is portrayed as solitary yet dependable -- someone who prefers quiet isolation but will unfailingly assist his friends in times of need: _____

Which quotation from The Hollow by the River most effectively illustrates the claim?

A: "Thornton arrived before anyone else had stirred, set the table for the whole party, and spent the morning refilling cups and clearing plates -- always nearby, always watching for what was needed next."

B: "Thornton kept to the far end of the property most days, preferring the company of his own thoughts to the noise of the village, and when visitors called he seldom answered."

C: "Thornton opened the door only a crack, scowling at the interruption, but the moment he saw how weary they looked he swung it wide, pulled them inside, and set about warming soup without another word of complaint."

D: "Thornton shook hands with each guest at the door, offered a few pleasant remarks about the weather, and then excused himself to sit alone by the fire until they left."

ANSWER: C

EXPLANATION: The claim requires BOTH solitary AND dependable in one quote. A shows dependable but sociable (always nearby). B shows solitary but unhelpful. D shows polite withdrawal but no dependability. C shows scowling at interruption (solitary) then immediately helping (dependable). TRICK: If a two-part claim uses 'yet' or 'but,' both halves must appear.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 2

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Claim-Example Match

DIFFICULTY: EASY

PROMPT: Urban planner Carla Reyes has claimed that pedestrian-friendly street redesigns increase foot traffic to local businesses.

Which finding, if true, would most directly support Reyes's claim?

A: A survey found that most drivers prefer streets with multiple vehicle lanes, though drivers who also walked regularly rated wider sidewalks more favorably.

B: Cities that completed pedestrian redesigns reported a 12 percent increase in overall city tax revenue in the following fiscal year.

C: After a street was redesigned with wider sidewalks, nearby residents reported feeling safer walking at night, though they did not report visiting local shops more frequently.

D: Retail sales at shops on a street redesigned with wider sidewalks and reduced vehicle lanes increased by 18 percent in the year following the redesign.

ANSWER: D

EXPLANATION: The claim is about foot traffic to LOCAL businesses after a STREET-level redesign. A is about driver preferences. B measures city-wide revenue, not local business traffic. C explicitly says no increase in shop visits, actually undermining the claim. TRICK: Match the exact scope -- 'local businesses' on the specific redesigned street, not city-wide.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 3

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Claim-Example Match

DIFFICULTY: EASY

PROMPT: Educator Samuel Yoon has argued that integrating visual art activities into elementary mathematics instruction helps students grasp abstract geometric concepts more quickly.

Which finding, if true, would most directly support Yoon's claim?

A: Students in classrooms with geometric artwork displayed on the walls scored higher on spatial reasoning tests than students in classrooms without such artwork.

B: Students who drew and colored geometric shapes as part of their math lessons scored higher on a subsequent geometry test than students who received traditional instruction without art activities.

C: Teachers who integrated art activities into mathematics instruction reported that students seemed more engaged, though test scores did not differ significantly between groups.

D: Students who independently chose to sketch geometric diagrams while studying scored higher on geometry assessments, and these students also tended to have prior experience in art classes.

ANSWER: B

EXPLANATION: Yoon claims INTEGRATING art INTO instruction helps. A is about wall decoration (passive environment, not instruction). C explicitly says no score difference. D is self-selected behavior with a confound (prior art experience). TRICK: 'Integrating into instruction' means teacher-led, not student self-selection or classroom decor.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 4

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Claim-Example Match

DIFFICULTY: EASY

PROMPT: *Gilt and Gravel* is a 1931 novel by Dorothy Ashford. The narrator describes the character Estelle as someone perpetually dissatisfied with her current circumstances and eager to project an image of wealth she does not possess: _____

Which quotation from the novel most effectively illustrates the claim?

A: "The moment Estelle fastened the borrowed pearls around her neck, her entire bearing shifted: she straightened, lifted her chin, and spoke in a clipped, airy tone that bore no resemblance to the voice she used at the shop counter."

B: "Estelle told Mrs. Hadley that she found their neighborhood quite beneath her standards, though she had lived there longer than anyone and showed no signs of leaving."

C: "At the charity auction Estelle bid confidently on a bracelet she could not afford, then slipped away before the auctioneer could call her name for payment."

D: "Estelle spent the evening rearranging the parlor furniture and mentioned to no one in particular that the room would look better with new curtains, though she made no effort to acquire them."

ANSWER: A

EXPLANATION: The claim requires BOTH dissatisfaction AND projection of wealth. B shows dissatisfaction through dialogue but no wealth projection. C shows deception at an auction, not sustained projection. D shows idle wishing, not active projection. A shows borrowed pearls (not her wealth) plus a changed persona (projection). TRICK: 'Projects an image' means actively performing a wealthier identity, not just complaining or hiding poverty.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 5

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Claim-Example Match

DIFFICULTY: EASY

PROMPT: Marine biologist Kira Tanaka has argued that the decline of kelp forests along the Pacific coast is primarily caused by the overpopulation of sea urchins, which graze on kelp holdfast structures.

Which finding, if true, would most directly support Tanaka's claim?

A: Kelp forests in areas with both high sea urchin populations and elevated water temperatures declined more rapidly than forests in areas with high urchin populations alone.

B: Sea urchin populations along the Pacific coast have increased by 60 percent over the past two decades, a period during which kelp forest coverage has declined by a similar proportion.

C: Coastal areas where sea urchin populations were experimentally reduced showed significantly faster kelp forest recovery than areas where sea urchin populations were left unmanaged.

D: Sea urchins in laboratory settings consumed kelp holdfasts at a rate sufficient to destroy a mature kelp plant within six weeks.

ANSWER: C

EXPLANATION: Tanaka claims urchin overpopulation is the PRIMARY cause. A introduces temperature as an additional factor. B shows correlation only, not causation. D shows lab capability but not real-world causation. C shows experimental removal of the cause followed by recovery. TRICK: The strongest causal support removes the proposed cause and observes the effect reverse.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 6

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Claim-Example Match

DIFFICULTY: EASY

PROMPT: Historian Margaret Chen has argued that the construction of transcontinental railroads in the nineteenth century accelerated the cultural integration of previously isolated communities in the American West.

Which finding, if true, would most directly support Chen's claim?

A: Railroad companies employed workers from diverse ethnic backgrounds who introduced their own cultural practices at construction camps along the rail line.

B: Towns along newly completed railroad routes adopted fashions, foods, and customs from distant regions more quickly than towns without railroad access.

C: Residents of towns along railroad routes reported that they valued cultural traditions from distant regions more highly than residents of towns without railroad access did.

D: The volume of goods shipped between eastern and western cities increased dramatically after the completion of the transcontinental railroad.

ANSWER: B

EXPLANATION: Chen's claim is about CULTURAL integration of COMMUNITIES. A is about construction workers, not settled communities. C shows attitudes (valuing traditions) not actual adoption. D shows trade volume, which is economic, not cultural. TRICK: Match both the subject (communities, not workers) and the outcome (cultural adoption, not commerce).

END QUESTION

QUESTION 7

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Claim-Example Match

DIFFICULTY: EASY

PROMPT: Psychologist Dara Okafor has claimed that exposure to natural environments reduces symptoms of attention fatigue more effectively than exposure to urban environments.

Which finding, if true, would most directly support Okafor's claim?

A: Participants who took a 30-minute walk in a wooded park reported feeling more relaxed than participants who walked along a busy city street.

B: Participants who took walks in parks and participants who took walks in urban settings both showed similar improvements on an attention test compared to participants who did not walk at all.

C: Participants who spent 30 minutes in a wooded park performed better on a subsequent attention test than participants who spent the same duration sitting quietly in an indoor waiting room.

D: Participants who took a 30-minute walk in a wooded park performed significantly better on a subsequent attention test than participants who walked for the same duration along a busy city street.

ANSWER: D

EXPLANATION: The claim compares nature vs. urban on ATTENTION. A measures relaxation, not attention. B shows equal improvement, actually undermining the claim. C compares nature vs. indoor rest, not nature vs. urban. TRICK: Match both the comparison (nature vs. urban) AND the outcome (attention, not relaxation or mood).

END QUESTION

QUESTION 8

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Claim-Example Match

DIFFICULTY: EASY

PROMPT: Nutritionist Leila Farid has argued that replacing refined grains with whole grains in school lunch programs would improve students' sustained attention during afternoon classes.

Which finding, if true, would most directly support Farid's claim?

A: Students who consumed whole-grain lunches maintained more consistent blood sugar levels and performed better on afternoon focus assessments than students who consumed refined-grain lunches.

B: Students who ate larger lunches, regardless of grain type, performed better on afternoon focus assessments than students who ate smaller lunches.

C: Students who consumed whole-grain lunches reported feeling fuller throughout the afternoon and were less likely to visit the school vending machines than students who consumed refined-grain lunches.

D: Students who ate lunch performed better on afternoon assessments than students who skipped lunch, and this effect was slightly larger for students who ate whole-grain lunches.

ANSWER: A

EXPLANATION: Farid claims whole vs. refined grains affect ATTENTION. B tests portion size, not grain type. C measures fullness and snacking, not attention. D mainly compares eating vs. not eating; the grain-type difference is secondary and weak. TRICK: The correct answer must test the EXACT comparison (whole vs. refined) on the EXACT outcome (attention).

END QUESTION

QUESTION 9

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Claim-Example Match

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: Sociologist Franklin Hayes has argued that the proliferation of social media platforms has not diminished the quality of civic discourse, as many critics contend, but has instead expanded the range of voices participating in public debates.

Which finding, if true, would most directly support Hayes's argument?

A: A study found that the total number of unique users posting about political topics on social media increased by 300 percent over a five-year period.

B: Researchers found that political discussions on social media were more likely to include factual citations than political discussions in print newspaper opinion sections.

C: A survey found that social media users rated the quality of online political discussions as lower than the quality of in-person political discussions.

D: A longitudinal study found that social media users from historically underrepresented demographic groups reported significantly greater participation in political discussions after adopting social media than before.

ANSWER: D

EXPLANATION: Hayes claims expanded RANGE OF VOICES, not just more posts. A shows more users but not more diverse voices. B supports quality but not voice expansion. C undermines the quality claim. TRICK: 'Range of voices' means demographic diversity of participants, not just higher post volume.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 10

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Claim-Example Match

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: A Gathering of Seasons is a 2003 novel by Anya Breckenridge. In the novel, the protagonist, Elara, is characterized as someone whose outward composure masks a deep internal turbulence: _____

Which quotation from A Gathering of Seasons most effectively illustrates the claim?

A: "Elara moved through the party with an ease that impressed everyone, laughing at the right moments and never once appearing distracted by the conversation around her."

B: "Elara folded her napkin precisely, aligned her silverware, and answered each question with the practiced calm of someone who had learned, long ago, that the tremor in her hands was visible only to herself."

C: "Elara excused herself from the table, walked to the garden, and wept so forcefully that when she returned her eyes were still swollen, and no one at the table pretended not to notice."

D: "Elara had always been the calmest person in any room, and even her closest friends believed that nothing troubled her -- an impression she had never had reason to correct."

ANSWER: B

EXPLANATION: The claim requires composure AND hidden turbulence. A shows composure only, no turbulence. C shows turbulence that is NOT hidden -- everyone sees her swollen eyes. D suggests she might genuinely be calm ('never had reason to correct'). TRICK: 'Masks' means both elements present simultaneously -- outer calm plus inner distress specifically concealed.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 11

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Claim-Example Match

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: Ecologist Naomi Sutherland has proposed that the introduction of beaver populations into degraded stream ecosystems accelerates the recovery of native fish species.

Which finding, if true, would most directly support Sutherland's proposal?

A: Streams where beavers were reintroduced showed a 40 percent increase in native trout populations within three years, while comparable streams without beavers showed no significant change.

B: Streams where beavers were reintroduced developed deeper pools and more varied channel structures, which are habitat features generally associated with healthy fish populations.

C: Native fish populations in streams with beaver dams were larger than native fish populations in streams without dams when both were surveyed at the same point in time.

D: Beavers reintroduced into degraded streams constructed dams at a faster rate than expected, and the dams were structurally similar to those built by wild beaver populations in undegraded streams.

ANSWER: A

EXPLANATION: The claim is about ACCELERATED RECOVERY of fish. B shows habitat improvement but not actual fish numbers. C is a cross-sectional snapshot that does not show recovery over time. D is about dam construction, not fish. TRICK: 'Accelerates recovery' requires a before-and-after comparison with beavers vs. without beavers.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 12

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Claim-Example Match

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: In the Stillness of Snow is a 1987 novel by Evelyn Moreau. The narrator describes the character Henrik as someone who uses humor to deflect from emotional vulnerability: _____

Which quotation from In the Stillness of Snow most effectively illustrates the claim?

A: "Henrik told the children a long, elaborate story about a bear who lost his spectacles, and by the end they were laughing so hard that even Henrik himself cracked a smile."

B: "Henrik sat alone on the porch after the funeral, and when his sister came to sit beside him he stood and walked inside without a word."

C: "When Marta asked if he had been hurt by her leaving, Henrik laughed and said the only thing that hurt was the price of the locksmith, and then he looked away and said nothing more."

D: "Henrik offered to fix the neighbor's fence without being asked, and when the neighbor tried to thank him, Henrik waved him off and said it was nothing worth mentioning."

ANSWER: C

EXPLANATION: The claim requires humor plus emotional vulnerability plus deflection. A has humor but no vulnerable moment. B has vulnerability but uses silence, not humor. D deflects gratitude, not vulnerability. TRICK: All three must converge -- a vulnerable question, a joke in response, and a sign of the real feeling underneath.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 13

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Claim-Example Match

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: Linguist Nora Fischer has argued that bilingual individuals who regularly switch between languages develop enhanced cognitive flexibility compared to monolingual individuals.

Which finding, if true, would most directly support Fischer's argument?

A: Bilingual participants who reported frequent code-switching performed better than monolingual participants on a memory recall task requiring them to remember long sequences of words.

B: Bilingual participants who reported frequent daily code-switching scored significantly higher on tasks requiring rapid shifts between different problem-solving rules than monolingual participants did.

C: Bilingual participants who used both languages at work reported less mental fatigue at the end of the day than monolingual participants in similar roles.

D: Bilingual participants outperformed monolingual participants on a task requiring sustained attention to a single rule applied consistently over a 30-minute period.

ANSWER: B

EXPLANATION: Cognitive flexibility means switching between rules or strategies. A tests memory. C tests fatigue. D tests sustained attention to a SINGLE rule, which is the opposite of flexibility. TRICK: 'Cognitive flexibility' on the SAT always means task-switching or rule-switching -- not memory, speed, or endurance.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 14

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Claim-Example Match

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: Agricultural scientist Obi Nwosu has argued that intercropping -- planting two or more crop species together in the same field -- can reduce pest damage without the use of chemical pesticides.

Which finding, if true, would most directly support Nwosu's claim?

A: Fields where maize was intercropped with beans experienced lower levels of stem borer infestation, but the reduction was observed only in fields that also received regular pesticide applications.

B: Fields where maize was intercropped with beans produced a combined harvest weight greater than the harvest weight of maize-only fields of the same size.

C: Laboratory tests found that chemical compounds released by bean plants attracted predatory insects that feed on stem borers, suggesting a possible mechanism for pest control.

D: Fields where maize was intercropped with beans experienced 35 percent less stem borer damage than fields where maize was planted alone, with no pesticides applied in either condition.

ANSWER: D

EXPLANATION: The claim is intercropping reduces pest damage WITHOUT pesticides. A shows reduction only WITH pesticides, contradicting the claim. B measures yield, not pest damage. C is a lab mechanism, not field evidence of actual pest reduction. TRICK: 'Without pesticides' must be explicitly confirmed -- if pesticides are present, it tests a different claim.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 15

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Claim-Example Match

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: The art historian Vivian Osei has argued that the murals painted on the walls of ancient Minoan palaces were not merely decorative but served a political function, reinforcing the authority of the ruling class by depicting scenes of royal ceremony and divine favor.

Which finding, if true, would most directly support Osei's argument?

A: Murals in the most politically significant rooms of Minoan palaces -- throne rooms and audience halls -- disproportionately featured scenes of rulers receiving offerings from subjects and interacting with deities.

B: The pigments used in Minoan palace murals were significantly more expensive than those used in domestic murals, suggesting that considerable resources were devoted to palace decoration.

C: Murals depicting scenes of rulers and ceremonies have been found in both elite and non-elite buildings throughout Minoan settlements, suggesting that such imagery was widely accessible.

D: Analysis of paint layering in Minoan palace murals indicates that the murals were periodically repainted, with newer layers featuring updated depictions of rulers in different ceremonial regalia.

ANSWER: A

EXPLANATION: Osei claims murals reinforced authority by depicting power scenes. B shows expense, not function. C shows the imagery appeared in non-elite spaces too, which UNDERMINES the authority claim. D shows repainting but not function. TRICK: The strongest support links CONTENT (what is depicted) to CONTEXT (where it appears) matching the claimed purpose.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 16

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Claim-Example Match

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: Public health researcher Amira Hassan has claimed that community-based exercise programs for older adults reduce the risk of falls more effectively than home-based exercise programs do.

Which finding, if true, would most directly support Hassan's claim?

A: Older adults who participated in a community exercise program reported exercising more total hours per week than those in a home-based program.

B: Older adults who did not participate in any exercise program experienced significantly more falls than those in either community or home-based programs.

C: Older adults enrolled in supervised group exercise classes experienced 25 percent fewer falls over a one-year period than a matched group performing the same exercises independently at home.

D: Older adults in community exercise programs showed greater improvements in balance scores than those in home programs, although fall rates were not tracked in the study.

ANSWER: C

EXPLANATION: Hassan compares community vs. home on FALLS. A measures exercise hours, not falls. B compares exercise vs. none, not community vs. home. D measures balance, not falls, and explicitly says falls were not tracked. TRICK: When a claim specifies an exact outcome (fewer falls), the correct answer must measure that exact outcome, not a proxy like balance.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 17

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Claim-Example Match

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: Beneath the Surface is a 2011 novel by Tomas Restrepo. The narrator portrays the character Valentina as someone whose meticulous attention to detail in her professional life contrasts sharply with the disorder she tolerates in her personal life: _____

Which quotation from Beneath the Surface most effectively illustrates the claim?

A: "Valentina's colleagues admired her efficiency, and her supervisor frequently cited her as an example for new hires to emulate."

B: "She had always preferred working alone, finding the noise of open-plan offices an intolerable distraction that left her feeling scattered by the end of each day."

C: "Valentina reorganized her home kitchen one Saturday, labeling each shelf and wiping every surface, but by Wednesday the counters were cluttered again and she could not summon the energy to restore order."

D: "At the office Valentina labeled every folder, color-coded every shelf, and kept a spotless desk; at home she stepped over piles of unopened mail and ate dinner standing at a counter crowded with unwashed mugs."

ANSWER: D

EXPLANATION: The claim contrasts professional meticulousness with personal disorder. A shows only the professional side. B is about work preferences, not the contrast. C shows meticulousness and disorder both WITHIN her personal life (home kitchen), not the professional vs. personal split. TRICK: Contrast claims require both domains -- each side must appear in its correct setting (office vs. home).

END QUESTION

QUESTION 18

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Claim-Example Match

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: Economist Sandra Liu has argued that raising the minimum wage in low-cost-of-living areas does not lead to significant job losses, contrary to predictions based on standard supply-and-demand models.

Which finding, if true, would most directly support Liu's argument?

A: A study of fast-food restaurants in high-cost-of-living cities found no significant employment change after a 10 percent minimum wage increase.

B: Counties with low living costs that raised their minimum wage by 15 percent saw no statistically significant change in employment levels over the following two years compared to similar counties that did not raise wages.

C: Counties that raised the minimum wage saw an increase in worker productivity, as employees at higher wages tended to stay longer in their positions.

D: Standard supply-and-demand models predicted significant job losses following minimum wage increases in low-cost areas, and these models have been validated in numerous other economic contexts.

ANSWER: B

EXPLANATION: Liu's claim: low-cost areas plus wage increase results in no significant JOB LOSSES. A tests the right outcome but in HIGH-cost areas, not low-cost. C measures productivity, not employment. D supports the opposing view. TRICK: Match all three conditions -- the geographic context (low-cost), the intervention (wage increase), and the outcome (employment levels).

END QUESTION

QUESTION 19

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Claim-Example Match

DIFFICULTY: HARD

PROMPT: Philosopher Rebecca Stanton has argued that moral intuitions -- the immediate, gut-level judgments people make about right and wrong -- should be treated as data points that ethical theories must account for, not as infallible guides to moral truth. Stanton maintains that when an ethical theory conflicts with a strong moral intuition, neither should be automatically discarded; instead, the conflict should prompt careful re-examination of both the theory and the intuition.

Which of the following scenarios, if true, would most clearly exemplify the approach Stanton advocates?

A: A philosopher encounters a case where a well-supported ethical framework yields a conclusion that most people find deeply objectionable, and responds by scrutinizing both the framework's assumptions and the cultural origins of the intuition before deciding which to revise.

B: A philosopher discovers that a moral intuition shared by most people can be traced to a specific cultural norm rather than to a universal principle, and concludes that the intuition should therefore be revised.

C: A philosopher accepts all moral intuitions as valuable data but argues that when a well-established ethical theory conflicts with an intuition, the theory should be given greater weight because it has been subjected to more rigorous scrutiny.

D: A philosopher surveys people from different cultures, finds that their moral intuitions differ on a particular issue, and concludes that moral intuitions cannot serve as reliable evidence for ethical theories.

ANSWER: A

EXPLANATION: Stanton says examine BOTH theory AND intuition without auto-favoring either. B auto-revises the intuition. C auto-favors the theory. D dismisses intuitions entirely. TRICK: Stanton's key phrase is 'neither should be automatically discarded' -- any answer that auto-favors one side violates her approach.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 20

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Claim-Example Match

DIFFICULTY: HARD

PROMPT: Archaeologist Dina Osman has proposed that a collection of small clay figurines excavated from a Neolithic settlement in Anatolia served a ritual function rather than a playful or artistic one.

Which finding, if true, would most directly support Osman's proposal?

A: The figurines display a high level of craftsmanship, with detailed features and smoothly polished surfaces that required significant time and skill to produce.

B: Chemical analysis of residues on some figurines revealed traces of ochre pigment, which has been found on both ritual objects and personal ornaments at other Neolithic sites.

C: The figurines were found exclusively in areas of the settlement associated with ceremonial activity, such as hearths surrounded by animal bones arranged in deliberate patterns, and none were found in domestic refuse deposits or children's burial sites.

D: Several figurines were found broken into pieces that could be reassembled, suggesting they may have been deliberately broken and perhaps repaired as part of a repeated practice.

ANSWER: C

EXPLANATION: Osman distinguishes ritual from playful or artistic. A supports artistic equally well. B is ambiguous since ochre appears on both ritual and non-ritual objects. D is ambiguous since breakage could be accidental or play-related. TRICK: The strongest evidence for a specific function ELIMINATES competing explanations -- found ONLY in ritual contexts AND NOT in others.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 21

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Claim-Example Match

DIFFICULTY: HARD

PROMPT: Musicologist Patricia Okafor has observed that West African drumming traditions influenced the development of syncopated rhythms in early jazz, but she emphasizes that this influence was not a simple transfer. Rather, Okafor argues, enslaved African musicians adapted West African rhythmic principles to the harmonic structures of European music they encountered in the Americas, creating a fundamentally new rhythmic language.

Which finding, if true, would most directly support Okafor's characterization of the influence as an adaptation rather than a simple transfer?

A: Musicologists have documented that specific West African drum patterns can be heard virtually unchanged in early New Orleans brass band recordings from the 1890s.

B: Enslaved African musicians were documented as performing European hymns in plantation churches, indicating familiarity with European harmonic conventions.

C: West African rhythmic traditions feature complex polyrhythmic structures that are markedly different from the rhythmic conventions of European classical music.

D: Analysis of early jazz recordings reveals rhythmic patterns that combine West African polyrhythmic structures with the diatonic harmonic progressions of European hymn traditions, producing combinations not found in either tradition alone.

ANSWER: D

EXPLANATION: Okafor says the result was a NEW synthesis, not a copy. A shows unchanged patterns, which is simple TRANSFER, not adaptation. B shows exposure to European music but not synthesis. C shows the traditions differ but not that they were combined. TRICK: 'Adaptation' means new combinations -- look for 'not found in either tradition alone.'

END QUESTION

QUESTION 22

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Claim-Example Match

DIFFICULTY: HARD

PROMPT: Behavioral economist Yuki Tanaka has argued that presenting nutritional information at the point of purchase -- such as calorie counts displayed on restaurant menus -- has a limited effect on consumers' food choices because most dining decisions are driven by habit and social context rather than by deliberate evaluation of nutritional data.

Which finding, if true, would most directly support Tanaka's argument?

A: A study found that customers who were given a brief educational presentation about nutrition before entering a restaurant ordered meals with significantly fewer calories than customers who were not.

B: A study found that restaurants that added calorie counts to their menus saw no statistically significant change in the average calorie content of meals ordered, even among customers who reported noticing and reading the calorie information.

C: A survey found that consumers who ate alone at restaurants reported paying more attention to calorie information than consumers who ate in groups.

D: A study found that when calorie counts were displayed on menus, customers who ate alone reduced their calorie intake significantly, while customers dining in groups did not change their orders.

ANSWER: B

EXPLANATION: Tanaka says point-of-purchase calorie info has LIMITED effect because of habit and social context. A tests a different intervention (pre-meal education, not menu labels). C shows attention differences but not behavior change. D shows the info WORKS for some, partially UNDERMINING the 'limited effect' claim. TRICK: 'Limited effect' is strongest when the info is present, noticed, and STILL does not change behavior.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 23

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Claim-Example Match

DIFFICULTY: HARD

PROMPT: The Cartographer's Apprentice is a 2015 novel by Ravi Deshmukh. The narrator characterizes the protagonist, Anand, as someone whose ambition is tempered by a persistent self-doubt that prevents him from fully committing to any course of action:

Which quotation from The Cartographer's Apprentice most effectively illustrates the claim?

A: "Anand drafted his resignation letter three times that evening, polishing each version until it gleamed with conviction, then folded all three into the desk drawer where they joined the others he had written and never sent."

B: "Anand spent the afternoon mapping a new route through the mountains, marking every elevation and water source with the precision his master had taught him, pausing only when his hand began to cramp."

C: "Anand's mentor told him he had a gift for precision and offered him the lead position on the next expedition, but Anand asked for a week to consider and spent that week imagining everything that could go wrong."

D: "Anand arrived at the harbor an hour before the ship was to depart, watched the crew loading the last of the cargo, and then turned and walked back toward the town without boarding."

ANSWER: A

EXPLANATION: The claim has three parts: ambition, self-doubt, and failure to commit. B shows skill and dedication, actually committing to work. C shows doubt (imagining failure) but no active ambition since he did not pursue the position. D shows inaction but no clear ambition or doubt. A shows writing resignations (ambition to change) plus never sending them (self-doubt prevents follow-through) plus 'joined the others' (pattern). TRICK: 'Tempered by' means the ambition EXISTS but is held in check -- both the drive and the block must be visible.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 24

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Claim-Example Match

DIFFICULTY: HARD

PROMPT: Climate scientist Ingrid Holm has argued that the current generation of global climate models systematically underestimates the rate of Arctic sea ice loss because the models do not adequately represent the albedo feedback loop -- the process by which melting ice exposes darker ocean water, which absorbs more solar radiation and accelerates further melting.

Which finding, if true, would most directly support Holm's argument?

A: Satellite observations show that Arctic sea ice has declined more rapidly than current climate models predicted over the past two decades.

B: Recent climate models that include enhanced albedo feedback representations have been tested primarily in Antarctic simulations, where they improved ice sheet predictions.

C: Satellite observations over the past two decades show that Arctic sea ice has declined at roughly twice the rate predicted by the ensemble average of current global climate models, and the discrepancy is largest in regions where the albedo feedback loop is most active.

D: Global climate models accurately predict the rate of sea ice loss in the Antarctic but significantly underestimate it in the Arctic, even when both polar regions are modeled using the same albedo parameters.

ANSWER: C

EXPLANATION: Holm's argument has TWO claims: (1) models underestimate Arctic ice loss AND (2) the albedo feedback loop is the reason. A supports only claim 1. B tests albedo in the wrong region (Antarctic). D shows underestimation but 'same albedo parameters' suggests the problem might not be albedo-specific. TRICK: When an argument gives both a claim AND a mechanism, the best support addresses both.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 25

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Claim-Example Match

DIFFICULTY: HARD

PROMPT: Neuroscientist Amara Okonkwo has proposed that sleep deprivation impairs moral judgment by weakening activity in the prefrontal cortex, the brain region most associated with evaluating the consequences of actions. Okonkwo argues that this impairment is specific to consequentialist reasoning -- judgments based on outcomes -- rather than to deontological reasoning -- judgments based on rules or duties.

Which finding, if true, would most directly support Okonkwo's proposal about the specificity of the impairment?

A: Participants who slept fewer than four hours performed significantly worse on both consequentialist and deontological moral dilemmas than participants who slept eight hours.

B: Brain imaging of sleep-deprived participants showed reduced activity in the prefrontal cortex during moral reasoning tasks, consistent with Okonkwo's claim about the neural mechanism.

C: Sleep-deprived participants took significantly longer to respond to both consequentialist and deontological dilemmas, suggesting a general cognitive slowdown rather than a targeted impairment.

D: Sleep-deprived participants performed significantly worse than rested participants on moral dilemmas requiring outcome-based evaluation but showed no impairment on dilemmas that could be resolved by applying a fixed moral rule.

ANSWER: D

EXPLANATION: Okonkwo claims SPECIFIC impairment to consequentialist reasoning. A shows impairment on BOTH types, contradicting specificity. B shows the mechanism but not specificity of the impairment type. C shows general slowdown on both, contradicting specificity. TRICK: Specificity claims require X IS affected AND Y IS NOT -- both must be tested and shown to differ.

END QUESTION